right to administer the slave trade. He then appealed to Rome to recognize the throne of Portugal as conducting, in Africa, a crusade: a holy war against the enemies of the Church, an assault on the powers of darkness.

Eugene IV had died in 1447; the Italian Nicholas V now sat on the papal throne. After brief consideration, he agreed to Afonso's request. On June 18, 1452, he issued the papal bull *Dum Diversas*, giving Afonso "full and free power, through the Apostolic authority . . . to invade, search out, capture, vanquish, and subdue all Saracens and pagans whatsoever, and other enemies of Christ wheresoever placed, and . . . to reduce their persons to perpetual slavery."[17]

In perpetuam servitutem: the bull had placed the papal seal of approval on the enslavement of the African captives. In all likelihood, Nicholas V was thinking more about the Turks than about the West Africans, since the bull simply gave Afonso the right to search out and enslave *all* pagans and seize their land. But three years later, when he confirmed the bull once more in the charter *Romanus Pontifex*, he took the further step of outlining the geographical areas in which Afonso could seize and enslave. Because the kings of Portugal had spent so much "labor, danger and expense" in sending "swift ships" to Africa, and because this had "caused to be preached to them the unknown but most sacred name of Christ," and because this had "gained for Christ" the souls of so many, the entire Portuguese enterprise was now protected by the Church. Only the Portuguese could sail to West Africa, preach the gospel, and bring Africans back to Europe.

> Fearing lest strangers induced by covetousness should sail to those parts, and desiring to usurp to themselves the perfection, fruit, and praise of this work . . . or should teach those infidels the art of navigation, whereby they would become more powerful and obstinate enemies to the king . . . and the prosecution of this enterprise would . . . perhaps entirely fail [with] great reproach to all Christianity; to prevent this and to conserve their right and possession . . . none, unless with [Portuguese] sailors and ships . . . and with an express license previously obtained from the said king . . . should presume to sail to the said provinces or to trade in their ports or to fish in the sea. . . . [T]hese islands, lands, harbors, and seas . . . do of right belong and pertain to the said King Alfonso and his successors . . . in order that [they] may be able the more zealously to pursue . . . this most pious and noble work . . . the salvation of souls.[18]

The conquest of the West Africans had been transferred into the realm of the holy; their enslavement had become their salvation; and their sale baptized